

COOLSHADE · CALCULATION

CoolShade sizing calculations

Open Hardware Portfolio · amishchadha.com

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Document ID	CSH-CAL-001	Version	0.1
Status	Draft	Date	2026-09-25
Author	Amish Chadha	License	CERN-OHL-S-2.0
Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/coolshade		
Source	docs/04-calcs/01-sizing.md @ 6f27f6b		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	First issue for TRL 3 (shade and space, headroom, misting and water, droplets and wetting, cooling, energy, wind and structure, handling, control and electrical, cost)

CoolShade sizing calculations

On paper, CoolShade meets ten of its seventeen requirements (five by calculation, four by design and one on published evidence), has three at risk, one that cannot be judged at TRL 3 and three that are not met. The three misses are R4 (air cooling of 2 °C at 1 m/s wind, where the calculation gives 1.35 °C averaged over the spray cycle), R10 (wind with the fabric fitted, where the fabric's edge pull at a 30 m/s gust overloads the 50 mm roof beams about 3.5 times on the conservative case) and R13 (cost, \$758 against the \$700 budget and the proposed \$750). The posts themselves are adequate: 0.29 utilization in the same gust. The calculations changed four details of the TRL 2 concept: shorter knee braces for headroom, a vacuum breaker so that the mist line can drain past its anti-drip nozzles, a closed mist line loop, and a strap on the tank, which tips over in a 30 m/s gust when empty. Every number in this note is printed by `docs/04-calcs/sizing.py`; the tag in brackets, for example [G7], is the line of that script's output that carries it.

Safety: These are first-principles screening estimates for a paper proof of concept. They are not a structural design to any code, they do not show that the mist is safe to breathe, and they do not replace an engineer's check of the frame, anchors and slab at a real site, or a water hygiene plan approved by the local health authority. See CSH-PRC-001, Safety.

■ Scope and method

The note checks every requirement in CSH-REQ-001 v0.3 against the design in CSH-PRC-001 v0.3 and the parametric model `cad/src/model.py`. The script imports the model's `PARAMS` and derived dimensions, so the post grid, roof heights, brace geometry, nozzle heights and mist line length used here are the ones in the STEP files and in drawing CSH-DWG-001. It also reads `bom/bom.csv` and `budget_usd` in `project.yaml`. Run it from the repo root with `python docs/04-calcs/sizing.py`.

The design day is unchanged from CSH-REQ-001: 38 °C air at 25 % relative humidity, clear sky, wind about 1 m/s, 5 h of misting demand and 4.5 peak sun hours. The humid edge is the wettest air in which the controller still mists: 32 °C at 60 % relative humidity.

■ Assumptions

Table 1. Main assumptions.

Area	Assumption	Basis
Nozzles	Eight 0.4 mm swirl nozzles at 7 bar (100 psi), 4 L/h each; spray 20 s on, 20 s off (50 %) during 5 h of demand; 87 % of the sprayed water evaporates in the air	TRL 2 estimates; flow to confirm from the maker's data
Air	Density 1.15 kg/m ³ , specific heat 1,006 J/(kg K), latent heat 2.43 MJ/kg; control volume 3.0 m long and 2.0 m high crossed at the wind speed; vapor diffusivity 2.6×10^{-5} m ² /s; viscosity 1.9×10^{-5} Pa s	Handbook values near 35 °C
Droplets	Surface at the wet-bulb temperature (Stull approximation); Stokes settling; nozzle jet carries droplets 300 mm below the tip before they move with the air; head height 1.5 m	Screening model; jet length assumed
Energy	Pump 60 W while spraying; controller and sensors 1.2 W continuous; normally open drain valve 5 W while held shut; 100 W panel, 4.5 peak sun hours, 0.75 system factor; 256 Wh battery, 80 % usable	TRL 2 estimates
Enclosure	200 W/m ² on its worst face under the cloth, absorptance 0.5, film coefficient 10 W/(m ² K), 5 W internal loss; LiFePO ₄ charging stops above 45 °C	Screening values; typical cell data
Wind	30 m/s gust, air 1.2 kg/m ³ ; net normal force coefficient 1.2 on the whole roof with the fabric treated as solid; center of pressure a quarter of the depth off center; friction 0.04 on each face; drag 2.0 on square sections and 0.8 on the tank; roof edge band 100 mm	Conservative screening values, not a code check
Steel	S275 (275 MPa yield), density 7,850 kg/m ³ ; partial factor 1.5 on wind, 0.9 on dead load	Common minimum grade for galvanized hollow sections
Fabric	Sags 5 % of its 2.4 m span under load	Assumed; knitted cloth stretch data needed
Tank	8 kg empty	Assumed
Space	0.5 m ² per standing person; wheelchair space 0.8 x 1.2 m; existing bench 1.5 x 0.42 m	R1 and site context

■ A. Shade and space (R1)

- **Shade area.** The roof is 7.20 m² in plan and 7.26 m² on the slope [A1]. Its shadow is 7.20 m² with the sun overhead and at least 6.30 m² for any sun elevation of 45° or more [A2], so R1's 6 m² is met.
- **Where the shadow falls.** With the sun at 60° elevation from the street side, only 2.11 m² of the shadow falls inside the canopy's own footprint; from along the curb, 3.33 m² [A2]. The shaded waiting spot moves with the sun, so the sun path check at each site (R1's verification) matters more than the roof area.
- **Space.** The clear floor between the posts is 2.72 x 2.02 m (5.49 m²). After the tank and pump, the bench and one wheelchair space, 3.59 m² remains, room for seven people standing plus three seated [A3]. R1 (six people and one wheelchair space) is met.

■ B. Headroom (R2)

- The roof beam underside is 2,896 mm at the front and 2,634 mm at the rear [B1].
- At TRL 2 the rear knee braces dropped 520 mm below the beam, leaving about 2,110 mm at the post face, below R2's 2,200 mm. The braces are now 400 mm down and 400 mm along the beam (45°, 566 mm long), and their low end is at 2,234 mm at the rear posts and 2,496 mm at the front posts [B2].

- The nozzle tips are at 2,584 mm (rear row) and 2,829 mm (front row); the sensor arm is at 2,300 mm and outboard of the front right post [B3]. R2 is met, with 34 mm to spare at the rear braces.

■ C. Misting and water (R7, R15, R9)

- **Nozzle flow.** A 0.4 mm orifice at 7 bar would pass 16.9 L/h as an ideal jet. The assumed 4 L/h implies a discharge coefficient of 0.24, which is plausible for a swirl nozzle that trades flow for fine atomization, but it must be confirmed from the maker's data [C1].
- **Daily water.** Eight nozzles spray 32 L/h, or 16 L/h averaged over the cycle, so the design day sprays 80 L and uses 85 L with the 5 L flush; about 69.6 L evaporates [C2]. R7 (100 L per day) holds up to 4.75 L/h per nozzle. At 5 L/h the day would use 105 L and R7 would not be met [C3].
- **Tank.** A full 120 L tank lasts 1.41 design days [C4]; R15 is met.
- **Drain-and-refill routine.** R9 limits tank water to 48 h old. Topping up a part-full tank never guarantees this, so the routine is to drain the residual and refill. Filling 95 L each design day leaves about 10 L to drain at the next visit, keeps every liter under 24 h old and draws 95 L per day; filling to 120 L and draining the rest would draw 120 L and miss R7 [C5].
- **Pump.** The hydraulic power is 6.2 W, so the assumed 60 W draw implies 10 % wire-to-water efficiency [C6], a conservative figure for a small diaphragm pump near its pressure limit.
- **Draining the mist line.** The line is now a closed loop under all four roof beams plus a down pipe: 10.96 m of 6.5 mm bore, holding 0.36 L. Through a 3 mm valve orifice at 0.5 m head it drains in about 27 s [C7], well inside R9's 5 min, but only if air can get in. Anti-drip nozzles close when the pressure drops, so the TRL 2 line would have held its water. A vacuum breaker at the front, highest point of the loop is added to BOM item 14.

■ D. Droplets and wetting (R5)

A droplet stops being a wetting risk once it has evaporated. On the design day the air can take up 8.9 g/m³ more water vapor at the droplet surface, and on the humid edge only 3.8 g/m³ [D1]. The lifetime of a droplet grows with the square of its diameter and its fall distance with the fourth power, so size is everything:

Table 2. Droplet lifetime and still-air fall [D2].

Diameter	Design day: life, fall	Humid edge: life, fall
30 µm	0.48 s, 6 mm	1.14 s, 15 mm
50 µm	1.34 s, 48 mm	3.17 s, 114 mm
80 µm	3.44 s, 316 mm	8.12 s, 745 mm
100 µm	5.38 s, 771 mm	12.68 s, 1,819 mm

Between the end of the jet under the rear nozzles and head height there are 784 mm. Droplets up to about 100 µm evaporate before reaching a head on the design day, and up to about 81 µm on the humid edge [D3]. R5 is therefore met only if the nozzle's droplet spectrum has nearly all its volume (Dv0.9) below about 80 µm at 7 bar. No maker's droplet data are in hand, so R5 cannot be judged at TRL 3. At 1 m/s wind, a 50 µm droplet drifts about 1.3 m before it is gone, and larger ones leave the canopy [D2]; this is the drift loss in the water balance.

■ E. Cooling (R4, R3)

- **Heat absorbed.** Evaporation absorbs 9.40 kW averaged over the cycle and 18.8 kW while spraying; 6.90 kg/s of air crosses the zone at 1 m/s [E1].
- **Air temperature drop.** The drop is 1.35 °C averaged and 2.71 °C while spraying. The air takes 3 s to cross the canopy, less than one 20 s pulse, so people feel the pulses rather than the average [E2].
- **R4.** The 2 °C averaged target is met only in wind below 0.68 m/s; at 0.3 m/s the drop would be 4.5 °C, but wetting risk rises in still air [E3]. R4 is not met at the design day's 1 m/s.
- **Limits.** The design-day wet bulb is 23.0 °C, 15.0 °C below the air, so misting is far from saturating the air; it adds 0.56 g/kg of humidity [E4]. The design day absorbs about 47 kWh of heat [E5].
- **Radiant heat (R3).** CoolShade's main benefit remains the shade. The published figure for shade sails in Tempe is a 17.3 °C drop in mean radiant temperature (Middel et al., 2021). R3 is taken as met on that evidence, but it is unverified for this fabric, and a globe thermometer measurement is needed later.

■ F. Energy (R8)

- **Use.** The pump takes 150 Wh, the controller and sensors 28.8 Wh and the normally open drain valve 25 Wh while held shut: 203.8 Wh per design day [F1].
- **Harvest and storage.** The panel yields 337.5 Wh, 1.66 times the use; the battery's 204.8 Wh usable covers 1.005 design days without sun [F2]. R8 is met by a margin of 1 Wh, which is no margin at all.
- **Latching valve option.** A latching drain valve would cut the use to 179.3 Wh and give 1.14 days, but a latching valve does not open by itself when power fails, so the line could sit full of warm water [F3]. The normally open valve is kept, and the choice is listed for Amish.
- **Currents.** Peak charge current is 7.4 A (the MPPT is rated 10 A) and the pump draws 4.7 A; the battery recharges from empty in 0.61 design days of sun [F4].
- **Heat.** The enclosure runs about 3.6 K above the air: 41.6 °C on the design day but 48.6 °C in 45 °C air. The battery stops charging above 45 °C, so charging stops whenever the air is above about 41.4 °C [F5]. On the hottest days the battery can only discharge. R8 is at risk.

■ G. Structure and wind (R10)

- **Mass.** The steel weighs about 143 kg before brackets and bolts: four posts 79.9 kg (a front post 20.9 kg), braces 4.1 kg, beams 32.6 kg, purlins 11.0 kg and base plates 15.2 kg. The dead load on the anchors, with panel, fabric, equipment and pump, is 152 kg (1.49 kN) [G1].
- **Wind.** A 30 m/s (108 km/h) gust gives 540 Pa, and with the fabric treated as solid, a normal force of 4.67 kN on the roof [G2].
- **Posts.** The horizontal load at roof level is 1.21 kN (the tilted roof, fabric friction and the roof edge) plus 86 N/m of drag on each post. As cantilevers with no help from the braces, the posts see 1.24 kN m each [G3], or 81 MPa with the 1.5 factor, a utilization of 0.29 of S275 [G4]. The TRL 2 figure of about 144 MPa came from applying the whole normal force sideways; that is not a physical load case, but even that bound gives a utilization of 0.80 [G5].
- **Roof beams in bending.** If the long beams simply carry half the roof pressure over the 2.8 m post spacing, they reach a utilization of 0.70 [G6].
- **Fabric edge pull.** A tensioned fabric does not load the beams like a floor. It pulls inward on its edges with a force that grows as its sag shrinks. At 5 % sag the edge pull is 3.89 kN/m on each long beam, which bends the 50 x 50

x 2 mm beam sideways at a utilization of 3.52 [G7]. The beams can take 1.11 kN/m. To stay within that, the fabric would need 422 mm of sag (18 % of its span), or its porosity would need to relieve 72 % of the pressure, or it would have to come off above gusts of about 16 m/s (58 km/h) [G8].

- **R10 is not met** on the conservative, solid-fabric case. Real knitted cloth is porous and stretches, both of which reduce the edge pull, but no data are in hand to show by how much. With the fabric removed, the frame carries only the panel, and the posts and beams are adequate. Removing the fabric before storms (decision D7) is therefore load-bearing, not a convenience. Options are listed in `docs/REVIEW.md`.
- **Anchors.** With the center of pressure 0.6 m off center, the worst post lifts with 1.83 kN, or 1.46 kN net of dead load and 2.41 kN factored [G9]. Adding the base moment over the 160 mm bolt pitch, each M16 anchor needs a factored tension of about 6.4 kN [G10]. Whether a given anchor in a given slab can provide it depends on the slab's thickness, concrete and edge distances, so the anchors cannot be verified at TRL 3. Without anchors, 324 kg of ballast would be needed [G11], so anchoring stays mandatory.
- **Tank.** An empty 8 kg tank sees 163 N of drag; its overturning moment of 57 N m is well above the 21 N m that holds it down, so it would tip [G12]. A strap to the rear left post and two small anchors are added to BOM item 13.

■ H. Handling (R17, R14)

The heaviest part is a front post with its brace at 22.0 kg, against R17's 40 kg; a long beam weighs 9.0 kg and the panel 7 kg. A full tank weighs about 128 kg and must be drained before it is moved [H1]. The frame has about 48 bolts and anchors and no welds [H2], so R14 is met by design; the 2-day build time cannot be checked on paper.

■ I. Control, electrical and hygiene (R6, R12, R9)

- **Control.** A 10 s control loop with a 20 s debounce on the temperature and humidity conditions stops the spray within 30 s of a condition failing, inside R6's 60 s [I1]. The lag of the sensor in its radiation shield is not known.
- **Electrical.** The largest continuous battery current is 7.4 A while charging and 5.2 A while misting, so a 15 A terminal fuse has a margin of 2.0 [I2]. R12 is met by design.
- **Tank temperature.** On design days the tank water settles near the daily mean air temperature plus some solar gain, about 34 °C (with an assumed 26 °C night), inside the 20 to 50 °C range in which *Legionella* grows (WHO) [I3]. R9 stays at risk: the design controls water age (under 24 h with the routine) and line draining (about 27 s), but not temperature.

■ J. Cost (R13)

The BOM has 16 lines, all priced, totaling \$758.00. That is \$58.00 (8.3 %) over the \$700 `budget_usd` and \$8.00 (1.1 %) over the \$750 proposed at TRL 2, which awaits Amish [J1]. The TRL 3 changes added \$23 (strap, vacuum breaker and a longer mist line). The steel lines (1, 2 and 4) come to \$230 for about 143 kg, about \$1.61/kg including cutting, drilling and galvanizing, which looks low for small quantities, so cost is at risk of rising further until quoted [J2]. R13 is not met against either figure.

■ K. Results against every requirement

Table 3. Requirement status from this note.

ID	Requirement	Value	Target	Status
R4	Air cooling from misting	1.35 °C averaged (2.71 °C while spraying) at 1 m/s [E2]	2 °C or more	Not met ; met below 0.68 m/s [E3]
R10	Wind resistance	Long-beam utilization 3.52 from fabric edge pull at 30 m/s [G7]; posts 0.29 [G4]; anchors 6.4 kN each [G10]	Survive 30 m/s with fabric fitted	Not met (conservative case); fabric must come off above about 16 m/s [G8]
R13	Cost	\$758 [J1]	\$700 or less (\$750 proposed)	Not met : +8.3 % and +1.1 %
R8	Energy autonomy	203.8 Wh used, 337.5 Wh harvested; battery 1.005 days [F2]	Energy-neutral; 1 day without sun	At risk: no margin; no charging above about 41 °C air [F5]
R9	Water hygiene	Water under 24 h old with the routine [C5]; line drains in about 27 s [C7]; tank about 34 °C [I3]	Age 48 h or less; drained within 5 min	At risk: water sits in the <i>Legionella</i> growth range
R16	Maintenance	Scaling of 0.4 mm orifices	Descaling interval 1 month or more	At risk; not verifiable at TRL 3
R5	No wetting	Needs Dv0.9 below about 81 µm at 7 bar [D3]	No wetting at 1.5 m	Not verifiable at TRL 3 (no droplet data)
R1	Shaded waiting area	6.30 m ² or more shadow above 45° sun [A2]; 7 standing + 3 seated + wheelchair [A3]	6 m ² ; 6 people and a wheelchair	Met
R2	Headroom	2,234 mm at the rear braces [B2]	2,200 mm or more	Met
R3	Radiant heat reduction	About 17.3 °C for shade sails (literature)	15 °C or more	Met on published evidence; unverified for this fabric
R6	Smart activation	Stop within 30 s [I1]	Within 60 s	Met by design
R7	Water use	85 L used, 95 L drawn [C2], [C5]	100 L or less	Met at 4 L/h per nozzle; at risk above 4.75 L/h [C3]
R11	Privacy	PIR only, no link fitted	No camera or microphone	Met by design
R12	Electrical safety	12 V DC, 15 A fuse, margin 2.0 [I2]	12 V, fused, IP65, BMS	Met by design
R14	Buildability	Bolted, about 48 fasteners [H2]	No welding; 2 days	Met by design; time unverified
R15	Refill interval	1.41 design days [C4]	1 day or more	Met
R17	Movability	Heaviest part 22.0 kg [H1]	40 kg or less	Met

In summary: 3 not met (R4, R10, R13), 3 at risk (R8, R9, R16), 1 not verifiable at TRL 3 (R5) and 10 met (R1, R2, R3, R6, R7, R11, R12, R14, R15, R17).

■ Checks against the TRL 2 figures

- Water (85 L), tank endurance (1.4 days), energy use (about 205 Wh), harvest (about 340 Wh), battery (about 205 Wh) and cooling (1.4 °C averaged and 2.7 °C while spraying) all stand.
- Parts cost rises from about \$735 to \$758.
- The post stress of about 144 MPa at TRL 2 was an upper bound; the physical case gives 54 MPa unfactored. R10 moves from "unverified" to "not met" because of the fabric edge pull, which the TRL 2 estimate did not consider.
- Headroom under the rear braces rises from about 2.1 m to 2,234 mm, so R2 is now met with margin.
- The TRL 2 structure mass of about 130 kg becomes about 143 kg of steel before brackets and bolts.